

Intro-Entertainment Industry ~ Week 6



Final Presentations

- November 30 and December 7
- Rubric is on D2L in Content section

Pictures

- Your picture should reveal something that makes the director, agent, or casting director want to meet you
- Talk to friends in the business about good photographers
- Excellent headshots are probably going to cost money--that said, sometimes you don't have a ton of money yet; do what you can with what you have to spend
- Avoid using friends, novices, etc.
- Good professional headshot photographers are specialists—they study the local market (markets have different styles)
- Meet with the photographer to see if you feel comfortable with them

- Good photographers will quiz you on how you want to be perceived, what you think your market is, what you want to convey in your picture, if you want a hair/makeup artist
- Designers and writers, you will need a headshot, too
- Professional photographers have websites—visit them to get a sense of their work
- Make sure you get a good close-up shot—most submissions are seen in thumbnails first, and ¾ shots don't work that small
- What do you like in a headshot?
- What do you think are the characteristics of good headshots?

Things to Consider

- It's not about looking pretty
- It's about showing your unique qualities
- Look into and through the lens rather than at the camera
- You want to appear to have a relationship with the person on the other side of the lens
- Beware of drooping necklines or shirts that stand up on your back, even when you adjust them
- Men—lose the facial hair (not a firm rule, but a good suggestion for actors especially)
- Women—you are not your hair
- If you change your hair color drastically, you'll need new headshots
- Minimal or no jewelry
- No hats (looks like you're trying too hard)
- No nose rings, studs, ear gauges, etc., unless you really want to be type casted

About Tattoos

- Small tattoos are usually okay now
- If you ever play anyone in a period before tattoos were widely used, you're going to need seriously expensive makeup to try to cover it up

- Think about your future as an actor before getting huge tattoos
- It's self-expression and it's you're right, but you're not usually playing YOU in a play or a film or commercial

The Good News/Bad News

- Bad news first: you are going to need new headshots every 12-18 months
- Good news: if you're not completely satisfied with your headshots, you get to change it up in a year or so

Reels

- When you do a voiceover, film, TV show, or commercial, you want to get a copy for your records.
- Voiceovers: ask the engineer or producer to send you a copy
- Film or TV: wait until it's released and then record it yourself
- Plays/Musicals: there are copyright issues, so make sure you check into that before recording; you will not be asked for this often in live theatre; must look professionally lit, framed, directed, and you must have appropriately professional hair, makeup costumes

Websites

- You might want to put this off until you're 3 or 4 years into your career
- Great place for your headshot, resume, photos of your work (for designers), reviews, reels
- The goal of the website is not to get you admired—it's to get you hired!
- Okay to use sites like www.wordpress.org or www.godaddy.com
- Your website can link to other sites (your agent might want to be on this decision)

How Do You Make A Good Impression Entering The Room? In an Interview/Audition?

Top Interviewing Tactics



- Research the company
- Know your own resume
- Make eye contact
- Study the job description
- Smile
- Listen (don't talk over the interviewer/auditioner)
- Body language
- BE YOURSELF
- Follow up after every interview/audition

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